

Struct, malloc

Jinyang Li

Structs

Struct stores fields of different types
contiguously in memory

What's a struct?

- Array: a block of n consecutive data of the same type.
- Struct: a collection of data of different types.
 - C has no support for object oriented programming
 - You can view structs as rudimentary “objects” without associated member functions

Define and access struct

```
struct student {  
    int id;  
    char *name;  
};
```

struct declaration:
a struct's fields are contiguous in memory,
with potential gaps, aka padding, in between.

```
struct student t;  
  
t.id = 1024;  
t.name = "alice";
```

define variable t with
type "struct student"

Access fields of the
struct variable

typedef struct

```
typedef struct {  
    int id;  
    char *name;  
} student;  
  
struct student t;
```

Pointer to struct

```
typedef struct {  
    int id;  
    char *name;  
} student;
```

P->name is
shorthand for
(*p).name

```
student t = {1023, "alice"};  
student *p = &t;  
p->id = 1024;  
p->name = "bob";  
printf("%d %s\n", t.id, t.name);
```

void * pointer

```
void memset_zero(void *p, int n)
{
    char *q = (char *)p;
    for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
        q[i] = 0;
}
```

How to make memset_zero
work with different variable types?

```
int main()
{
    student s;
    memset_zero(&s, sizeof(s));

    teacher t;
    memset_zero(&t, sizeof(t));
}
```

memset is part of stdlib.

Malloc

Allocates a chunk of memory dynamically

What's malloc?

- A collection of stdlib functions for dynamic memory allocation (with OS' help):

- malloc: allocate storage of a given size

```
void *malloc(size_t size);
```

- free: de-allocate previously malloc-ed storage

```
void free(void *ptr);
```

C vs. Java

Java

```
class Foo {  
    int x;  
    double y;  
  
    //constructor  
    Foo(int x, double y) {  
        this.x = x;  
        this.y = y;  
    }  
}  
  
//later in code somewhere...  
Foo f = new Foo(1, 3.14);
```

C

```
#include <stdlib.h>  
  
typedef struct {  
    int x;  
    double y;  
} Foo;  
  
//later in code somewhere...  
Foo *p = malloc(sizeof(Foo));  
p->x = 1;  
p->y = 3.14;  
  
free(p);
```

C's malloc $\approx$ java's new - initialization

C's free $\approx$ java's garbage collection

Memory allocation for global and local variables

- **Global** variables are allocated space before program execution.
- **Local** variables are allocated when entering a function and de-allocated upon its exit.

Allocating a new array?

```
int *newArray(int n) {  
    int arr[n];  
    return arr;  
}
```



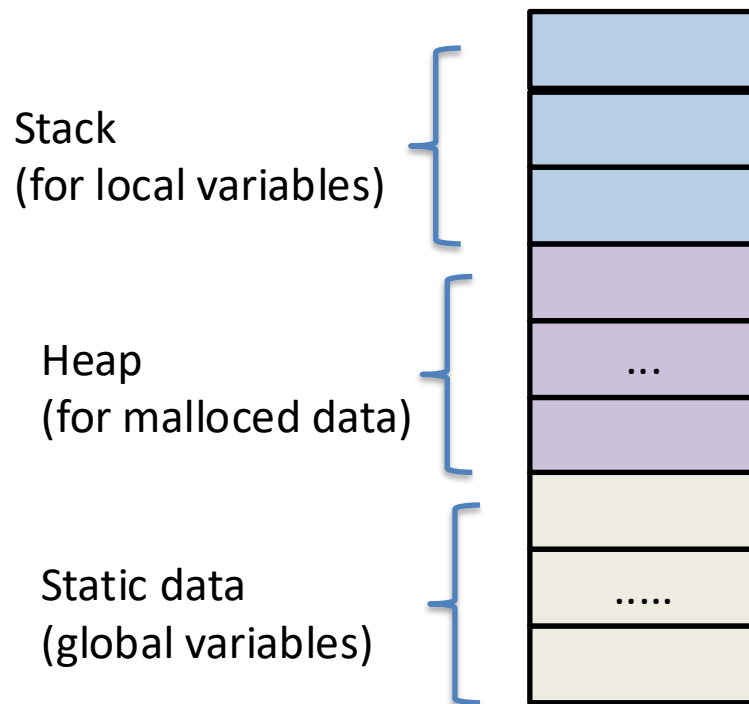
```
int main() {  
    int *r;  
    r = newArray(1000);  
    //do something with the array  
    ...  
}
```



```
int *newArray(int n) {  
    int *p;  
    p = (int*)malloc(sizeof(int)*n);  
    return p;  
}
```

Conceptual view of a C program's memory at runtime

- Separate memory regions for global, local, and malloc-ed.



We will refine this simple view in later lectures

Linked list

```
typedef struct {  
    int val;  
    struct node *next;  
}node;
```



```
node *find(node *head, int val) {  
    node *n = head;  
    while (n) {  
        if (n->val == val)  
            break;  
        n = n->next;  
    }  
    return n;  
}
```

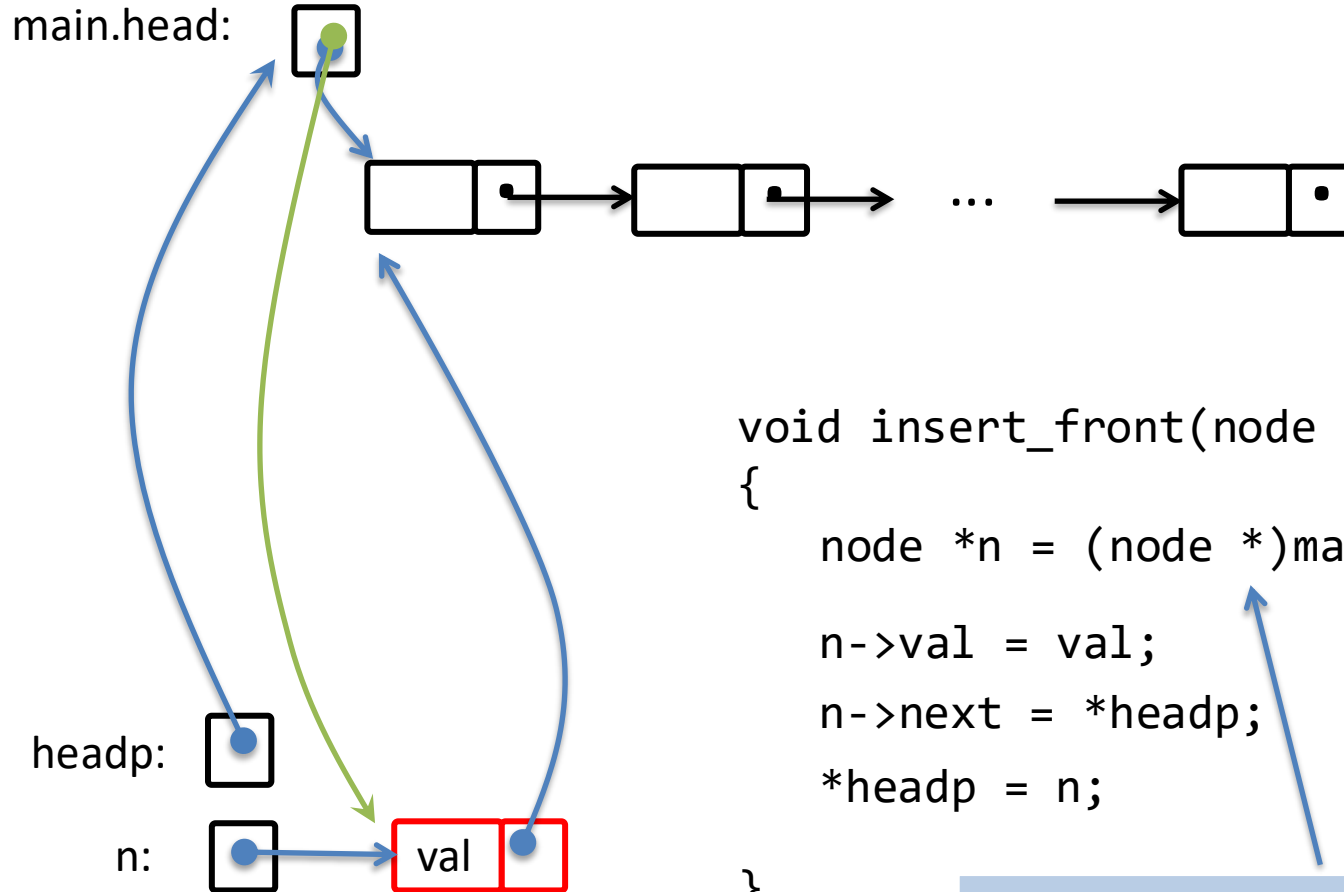
Linked list in C: insertion

```
// insert a new node with val in the front of the linked list
node *insert_front(node **headp, int val)
{

}
```

```
int main() {
    node *head = NULL;
    for (int i = 0; i < 3; i++)
        insert_front(&head, i);
}
```

Inserting into a linked list



```
void insert_front(node **headp, int val)
{
    node *n = (node *)malloc(sizeof(node));
    n->val = val;
    n->next = *headp;
    *headp = n;
}
```

replace line with following?
node new_node;
node *n = &new_node;



Linked list in C: removal

```
// remove node with val from linked list
```

```
void remove(node **headp, int val)
```

```
{
```

```
}
```

```
int main() {
```

```
    node *head = NULL;
```

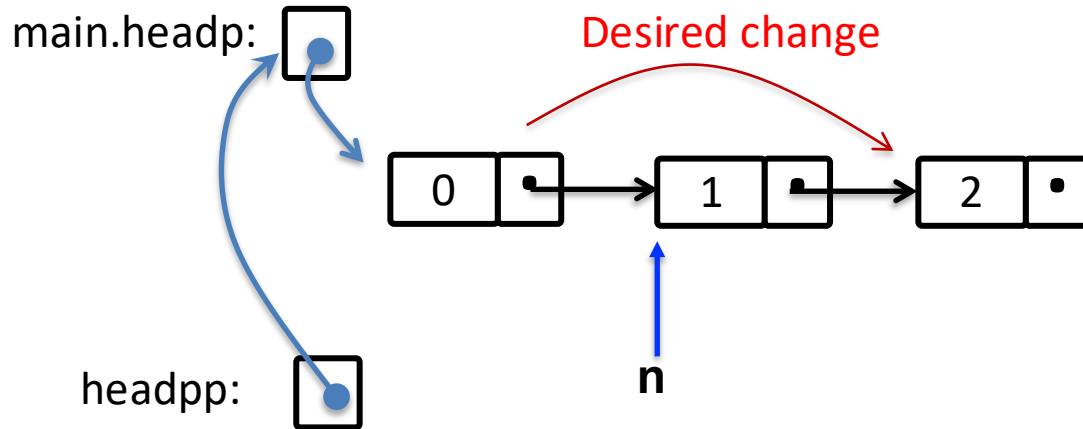
```
    for (int i = 0; i < 3; i++)
```

```
        insert(&head, i);
```

```
    remove(&head, 1);
```

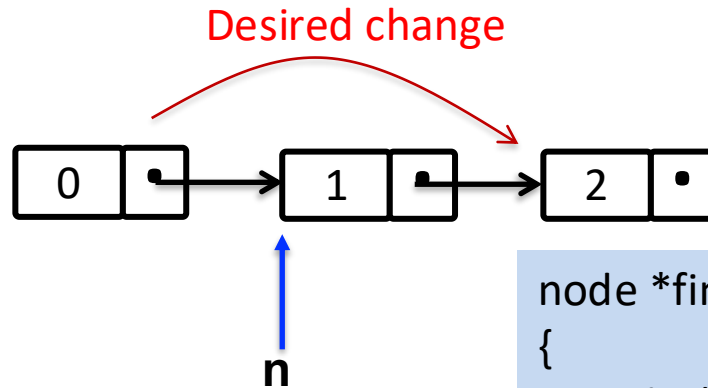
```
}
```

Removing from a linked list



```
void remove(node **headp, int val)
{
    node *n;
    n = find_node(*head, val);
    // ??? How to get to n's predecessor?
}
```

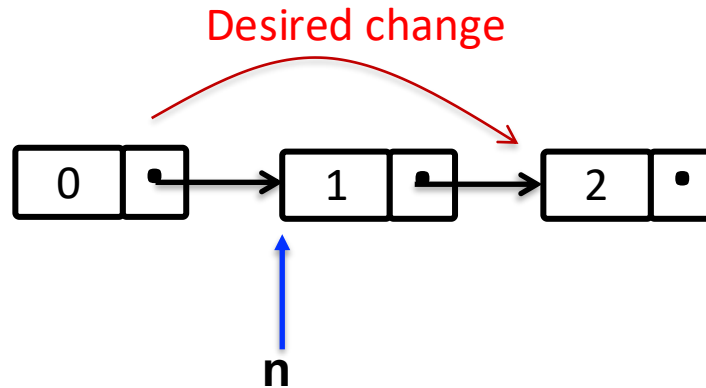
Removing from a linked list



```
void remove(node **headp, int val) {  
    node *n;  
    node *pred;  
    n = find(*headp, val, &pred);  
}
```

```
node *find(node *head, int val, node **predp)  
{  
    node *n = head;  
    node *pred = NULL;  
    while (n) {  
        if (n->val == val)  
            break;  
        pred = n;  
        n = n->next;  
    }  
    *predp = pred;  
    return n;  
}
```

Removing from a linked list



```
void remove(node **headp, int val) {  
    node *n;  
    node *pred;  
    n = find(*headp, val, &pred);  
    if (!n)  
        return;  
    if (!pred)  
        *headp = n->next;  
    else  
        pred->next = n->next;  
    free(n);  
}
```

Two corner cases:

1. val is not in the list
2. n is the head

Summary

- Struct
 - Group variables together into a primitive “object”
- Malloc
 - Allocate data on the heap
 - Must be explicitly free-ed by programmers